

Sara Radwan.

Senior Art Director · Brand Strategist · Arabic-English Creative Lead

hello@sarahradwan.me · sarahradwan.me · linkedin.com/in/sarahradwan1 · Abu Dhabi, UAE · Available Internationally

PROFILE

Senior Art Director and Brand Strategist with 22 years of experience across Egypt, Qatar, and the UAE. Specialises in bilingual Arabic-English creative direction, government institutional design, and visual communication systems — from annual reports and infographic systems to national-scale publication design and brand identity. Currently completing CIM Level 7 Postgraduate Diploma in Professional Marketing.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Art Director · Brand & Creative Lead

Feb 2025 – Present

WeDo Advertising & Publicity

Abu Dhabi, UAE

- Lead art direction and creative production for UAE government and institutional clients across identity systems, publications, campaigns, and digital communications.
- Design and produce bilingual Arabic-English institutional publications, annual reports, infographic systems, and strategic communications materials.
- Manage external vendors, print production partners, and digital developers from brief through final delivery.
- Contribute to government tender development through creative proposal and concept work.
- Contributed to 12% government tender win rate through structured proposal development

Selected clients: UAE Aid Agency (Ministry of Foreign Affairs) · SCAD · Abu Dhabi Fund for Development · Dubai Municipality · Family Development Foundation · Islamic Affairs Dubai

Co-Founder · Creative Director

Aug 2021 – Jun 2024

Social Dar Marketing Management

Dubai, UAE

- Co-founded and directed a creative studio delivering brand strategy, identity, and communications for UAE corporate clients.
- Managed full project lifecycle - brief, strategy, design direction, team coordination, and delivery.
- Built long-term retainer relationships across technology, risk management, and government-adjacent sectors.

Selected clients: Emerald Solutions Group - 4-year brand retainer, bilingual EN/ES website, brand architecture for UAE/Pakistan/Ukraine/Kenya subsidiaries, Act Air UAE - full brand creation, MENA's first interactive hologram company · RTA UAE - employer brand and recruiting fair 2023

Art Director · Marketing & Communication Lead

Jul 2024 – Jan 2025

Countdown Media Production Services

Dubai, UAE

- Led art direction and brand communications for multiple client accounts across digital and print.
- Produced campaign materials and brand consistency frameworks for UAE clients.

Creative Director · Team Lead

2019 – 2021

UAE Ministry of Education — via Ibtikar Edu Tech Solutions

UAE

Independent contract · Project value: AED 2,000,000 (~€500,000)

- Contracted directly as Creative Director and Team Lead for the UAE national curriculum textbook design system, 100+ books across five subjects, three languages (Arabic, English, French).
- Built complete visual system: cover designs, interior layout templates, multilingual typography, subject colour-coding, and interactive ePub digital editions with embedded multimedia.
- Led design team of illustrators, designers, and layout specialists throughout delivery.

Creative Director · Full Event Identity

DAIS 2019 — Dubai Sports Council

Independent project

2019

Dubai, UAE

- Led full creative direction for Dubai's first AI in Sports international conference and exhibition, identity system, billboards, newspaper advertising, entry tags, environmental signage, and Snapchat geofilter.

Art Director · Fashion & Beauty Editor

CPI Media Group

Leading UAE publishing group — 20+ print and digital brands, 8 award programmes

2015 – 2020

Dubai, UAE

- Art directed 20+ print and digital brands across fashion, beauty, lifestyle, and B2B sectors.
- Led full rebranding of MBC magazine, website, and awards programme.
- Directed editorial photoshoots, layouts, and marketing communications.
- ▶ +38% subscriber growth following MBC rebrand

Head of Creative

Al Arab Newspaper

Qatar's first post-independence Arabic publication · Est. 1972

2010 – 2015

Doha, Qatar & Cairo, Egypt

- Redesigned full newspaper layout and directed weekly supplements: arts, sports, automotive, lifestyle.
- Designed institutional Kahramaa supplement contributing ~€1,000,000 in revenue for the publication.
- Trained and managed the design team.

EARLIER CAREER

Senior Graphic Designer · Team Leader — Bardi Publishing House

Cairo, Egypt

2006 – 2009

- Led design team for a ~€460,000 UNICEF educational publishing project : 32 selected by UNICEF, the highest selection rate of any participating publishing house.

Graphic Designer — Jedco Pharmaceuticals

Cairo, Egypt

2004

SKILLS

Art Direction & Visual Communication

- Visual identity systems and brand guidelines
- Bilingual Arabic-English creative direction
- Government institutional communications
- Campaign concepting and art direction
- Editorial photoshoot direction
- Environmental and event design

Publication & Information Design

- Annual reports and institutional publications
- Complex infographic and data visualisation
- Multilingual typesetting: Arabic, English, French
- Interactive ePub digital editions
- Long-form editorial layout systems
- Print production and prepress

Strategy & Brand

- Brand strategy and positioning
- Brand architecture for group structures
- Government tender and proposal development
- Long-term retainer management
- Workshop facilitation and client advisory

AI & Technology

- AI image and video generation
- AI brand guidelines integration
- AI-assisted research and proposal development
- Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop

EDUCATION

CIM Level 7 — Postgraduate Diploma in Professional Marketing

Oxford College of Marketing · Chartered Institute of Marketing · Equivalent to a postgraduate degree

In progress

BCS Advertising & Graphic Design

Faculty of Applied Art · Helwan University · Cairo, Egypt

2003

LANGUAGES

Arabic Native · English C2 — Fluent · French A2 · German A1